umbrella," Aspect said. "He protected me against all these people who were telling him, you are guilty to let this young guy waste his time, he should do some real physics rather than doing that. And I did not realize that so much." Finally, in 1982, Aspect and his collaborators published their results: Bell's inequality was still violated, even when the polarizers were switched while the photons were in flight.

Aspect followed up on his experimental tour de force with an even more astonishing and difficult act. "If you speak to an 'ordinary' physicist about hidden variables and testing hidden variable theories against quantum mechanics, basically, they are not interested," Aspect said. "But, if you tell them, there is a nice experiment looking for correlations, and these correlations are extraordinary, then they are likely to listen to you, because physicists like nice experiments, and [testing Bell] is a nice experiment, there is no doubt." Aspect, a teacher at heart—"I was myself fascinated, so when you are fascinated, you should be able to transmit your fascination, right?"—found a way to talk with other physicists about Bell's theorem. "I like to explain. And I think I found the right way to explain… why [this experiment] is interesting, in less than 30 minutes," Aspect said. "I got a way of explaining to an ordinary physicist why it is really interesting. And so, after a while, you are invited to give a seminar, and if the seminar is well received, there are other people in the room who will invite you to give another seminar here and there, and [ultimately] I really gave many many many seminars to explain Bell's inequalities, and the interest of doing these experiments, the way I was understanding it." Aspect's series of talks turned out to be one of the final cracks in the edifice of silence that Copenhagen had constructed. In the 1980s, for the first time in half a century, large numbers of physicists began to openly question the Copenhagen interpretation. Copenhagen still held a strong majority, and not all of those who questioned it thought it was wrong. But the avalanche of dissent, held back for so long, finally came barreling down the mountain. The new field of quantum foundations had arrived.